

G. Jake Chanenson

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I study whether technology is safe for children and youth through empirical and legal-informed lenses. My research documents how K–12 schools and AI systems collect and use student data, where the law falls short, and what accountability looks like in practice. Finishing a CS PhD at UChicago (spring 2027) with a Master of Legal Studies from UChicago Law, I am looking for roles in policy, government, or industry research where that combination is directly useful.

EDUCATION

University of Chicago

Ph.D., Computer Science (Advisor: Marshini Chetty)

Master of Legal Studies, Chicago Law, emphasis on privacy, copyright, & administrative law

M.S., Computer Science, Thesis: Privacy Challenges in K–12 Schools

Chicago, IL

Expected Spring 2027

June 2024

June 2023

Swarthmore College

B.A., Computer Science; Minors: Mathematics, Engineering

Swarthmore, PA

May 2021

EXPERIENCE

Research Intern

Google (Supervisor: Sunny Consolvo)

Fall 2024 – Spring 2025

Remote

- Published study (*ACM CHI 2026*, premier HCI venue) on the emotional experience of online scam victimization and what intervention points exist for platform designers, fraud prevention teams, and consumer protection agencies.

Lead Researcher: Children’s Privacy & AI Safety

University of Chicago

Fall 2021 – Present

Chicago, IL

- Documented systematic failures in how U.S. K–12 schools protect student data through school audits, administrator interviews, and EdTech privacy policy analysis. Findings covered by *USA Today*, *The Markup*, *EdSurge*, and others.
- Found that high school students are using generative AI with little institutional guidance and significant privacy risk; co-organized CHI 2026 international workshop on developmentally safe AI design for youth. Paper forthcoming at *ACM FAccT 2026* (leading AI accountability venue).
- Demonstrated that LLMs can automate privacy policy annotation at scale, reducing burden on regulators and advocates conducting compliance audits, with specific failure modes that require human oversight. Published in *PoPETs 2025*.

POLICY & REGULATORY ENGAGEMENT

- FTC Comment on COPPA** (Feb. 2024): Co-authored public comment on proposed Children’s Online Privacy Protection Rule amendments (Docket FTC-2021-0019).
- EDPB Comment on Dark Patterns** (May 2022): Co-authored public comment to the European Data Protection Board on dark patterns in social media.
- Privacy Law Scholars Conference** (Washington DC, Spring 2024): Presented working paper on data trusts as a governance mechanism for K–12 student data.
- Invited Talks**: Madison Security & Privacy Seminar (Winter 2025); Sony AI Ethical AI Seminar (Winter 2025).

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Chanenson** et al. “Investigating ChatGPT Usage in High Schools: Student Perspectives on Policy and Practice.” *To appear, ACM FAccT 2026*.
- Chanenson** et al. “‘It didn’t feel right but I needed a job so desperately’: Understanding People’s Emotions and Help Needs During Scams.” *ACM CHI 2026*.
- Chanenson***, Pickering*, Apthorpe. “Automating GKC-CI Privacy Policy Annotations with Large Language Models.” *PoPETs 2025*.
- Chanenson** et al. “Uncovering Privacy and Security Challenges in K–12 Schools.” *ACM CHI 2023*. **Best Paper Honorable Mention**.

TEACHING & PUBLIC COMMUNICATION

- Instructor of Record**, CMSC 14100: Intro to CS I, University of Chicago (Summer 2026); designed and taught CS and human-centered design courses to 65+ underserved Chicago-area high school students (2022–23).
- Podcast Host**, *New Books Network: Science, Technology & Society* (Fall 2022–Present): interviews scholars on technology, privacy, and policy for a general audience of over one million monthly listeners.

SELECTED HONORS

CITAP Affiliate, UNC Chapel Hill (2023–Present) · CHI Best Paper Honorable Mention (2023) · Crerar Fellowship, UChicago (2021) · Lockwood Fellowship, Swarthmore (2021) · IEEE VR Best Poster Honorable Mention (2019) · Sigma Xi Member